

Byu Pathways Service Missionary Guidebook

*This is a web-handbook that will be updated
regularly*

Welcome to BYU Pathways Service Mission!
Pathways is constantly changing to
accommodate our growth of students, classes,
and service missionaries.

Because of this please check back regularly for
updated information.

If you have any questions please contact your
District Leaders or Zone Leaders.



*"Our purpose is to help youth and young adults deepen their
conversion to Jesus Christ and His restored gospel, qualify for
the blessings of the temple, and prepare themselves, their
families, and others for eternal life with their Father in
Heaven."*

Recent News

2026	Winter Semester		Spring Semester		Winter Semester	
	Term 1	Term 2	Term 3	Term 4	Term 5	Term 6
Start Mondays	January 5	March 2	May 4	June 29	August 31	October 26
End Saturdays	February 21	April 18	June 20	August 15	October 17	December 12
	1 Week break	2 week break	:There is a 1 week break between terms and 2 week break between semesters			

Brother Christensen's
Micro Training

[Master List of trainings](#)

Training Expectations

3 Week Training course: You will go through an introductory teacher training course with Brother Christensen. This will be your main source in learning to Focus on Jesus Christ, Teaching the Doctrine, and Inviting Diligent Learning.

During this training you'll be contacted about your missionary tag, Zoom Pro account and BYU pathway email.

(Be patient as these can take a week or two to provision.)

7 Week 1st term training: Alongside your first class you will go through our 1st term teacher training with your Training District Leader. You will meet once a week where we will help you:

- Log into Canvas

- Log into Zoom

- Learn how to use Canvas (announcements, modules, class lists, and grading)

- Learn how to use Zoom (Your zoom link, hosting a class, breakout rooms, share screen)

2nd Term training: During your second term you will meet bi-weekly with your new 2nd Term Training District Leader.

Here you will review:

- Zoom tech, Canvas tech, Teaching in the Savior's way

District Placement: In your third term you'll be placed with your regular District Leader who will help and guide you as needed throughout your classes.



Yearly Compliance training: You will be contacted about this during the training period around August-October. This is standard Church workforce training and will need to be done every year, however some teachers are unable to log in. If you have this issue let your District Leader know.

Religion Courses information

What course will I be teaching?

Each term you will be assigned to teach one of the following seven courses offered to Pathway students. Students are invited but not required to register for classes in the following order:

REL 250: Jesus Christ and His Everlasting Gospel • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

REL 275: Teachings & Doctrine of the Book of Mormon • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

REL 225: Foundations of the Restoration • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

REL 200: The Eternal Family • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

REL 290: The Divine Gift of Forgiveness • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

REL 333: Teachings of the Living Prophets • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

REL 280: Answering My Gospel Questions • [Part A](#) • [Part B](#)

These are links to the SandBox courses.

There are no students or classes in these. Feel free to use them for Substituting or exploring classes you may be interested in teaching.

Courses have 28 weeks

Part A

Lessons 1-14

2 lessons per week

Part B

Lessons 15-28

2 lessons per week

What do students study? Students are given both topics to study and pick *one* lesson to study for the week

What do teachers study? Teachers discuss both topics/lessons each week

See Next Page for examples

Remember these are Discussion based classes. Students have already studied the subjects and your role is not to teach the material again, but to encourage them to dig deeper and help them connect the Saviors Gospel to their own lives.

Religion Courses information

▼ Week 02: Trusting Jesus Christ, Our Premortal Savior and Leader & Finding Purpose and Joy in the Lord's Creations

Complete All Items

Lesson 3 Teacher Materials

Lesson 4 Teacher Materials

Due Midweek

W02 Connection
Jan 16, 2025 View

W02 Readings
Jan 15, 2025 2 pts Submit

Due End of Week

W02 Attendance
Jan 18, 2025 3 pts Submit

W02 Reflection
Jan 18, 2025 2 pts Submit

This is what *teachers* see.
Notice there are lessons 3 & 4
You will study both lessons and discuss them in class. You will not get through everything in both lessons so prayerfully consider the needs of your class.

W02 Readings

Due Jan 15, 2025 at 11:59pm

Points 2

Questions 1

Available until Jan 29, 2025 at 11:59pm

Time Limit None



Prepare to learn by listening to a hymn or song. Create a note in the Notes section of Gospel Library to record your thoughts and impressions. Begin with prayer.

"There has never been a time in the history of the world when knowledge of our Savior is more personally vital and relevant to every human soul" (President Russell M. Nelson, "Pure Truth, Pure Doctrine, and Pure Revelation," *Liahona*, Nov. 2021, 6). Each week, you will study questions related to Jesus Christ and discuss what you are learning with your peers.



Study

Choose **one** topic to study. Then start the quiz below when you're ready to report on your studies.

► Topic A: Our Premortal Savior

► Topic B: Finding Purpose in Creation

Select **Take the Quiz**.

This quiz was locked Jan 29, 2025 at 11:59pm.

◀ Previous

Next ▶

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This is what the *students* will see. They choose **one** topic to study each week.

Zoom Settings and set up

First time log in

You will be emailed that you have been provisioned a pro zoom account. Using your BYU Pathway email you can log in and see your new pro Zoom account.

If you have not gotten this email you can still try to log in to see if the email was delayed.

Zoom Link

<http://zoom.us/>

You will use your **personal meeting room zoom link** for each class. When you've logged in click on the *meetings* on the left side tab beside your profile.

Then **Personal Meeting room**. On the top row.

The **blue link** is your personal meeting room zoom link.

**Make sure to copy this to your class, as well as your Zone Excel Teacher list.*

Zoom Settings

You must make sure your settings are correct for your class.

- Auto record on
- Waiting room disabled
- Students may join before host

These settings ensure substitutes may enter your class in an emergency.

For step by step instructions please follow this PDF that will show you exactly how to do this.

[Zoom Settings Instructions PDF](#)

Zoom link

Which Zoom link should I use for class?

In Meetings
Under *Personal Room*
You'll see a blue link with
byupathways on it.
That is the link you will use for all
classes
Save it

*Do not use the zoom link from
profile.

It looks like this



https://byupw.zoom.us/j/*****964?pwd=piTTPAYKnD5X9HPc1bCFp1hFof54an.1

This will not work

The screenshot shows the Zoom web interface for a 'Personal Room'. The left sidebar contains a navigation menu with options like Profile, Meetings, Webinars, etc. The main content area is titled 'Meetings' and shows details for a room named 'Sister Victoria Peterson's Personal Meeting Room'. The 'Invite Link' is highlighted with a green circle and is the URL: <https://byupw.zoom.us/j/3075787964?pwd=piTTPAYKnD5X9HPc1bCFp1hFof54an.1>. Below the link are buttons for 'Google Calendar', 'Outlook Calendar (.ics)', and 'Yahoo Calendar'. At the bottom, there are buttons for 'Start', 'Copy Invitation', and 'Edit'.

Canvas Settings and App

You should not see your training course on your canvas.

If you do your in the wrong one. (it may have no course, or an unpublished course)

Sign out by clicking the profile picture

Sign back in with your byu pathway email

If it still struggles sign in with an incognito window

Sign in using byupw.instructure.com

*You should be present in your class often.
Check on connect, comment, like, comment
on reflections, or just check in.
Teacher presence is a comfort and welcomed
presence for students.*

Canvas has a teacher app!

- ☐ Turn on notifications to get messages from students from your phone
- ☐ You can also grade reflections directly on the app
- ☐ Stay connected in the connect



Resources available to you

Did you know that you have access to Office 365?

Office, Excel, Powerpoint, and more.

Just log in using your BYU Pathway email

Additional resources for lesson planning

Resources Microtraining

ldsbots.com

An AI chat bot that uses only LDS references for searches.

For questions like: *What are some conference talks that discuss Jesus Christ being the creator of the earth?*

Should only be used as a search engine for finding original references.

*All answers should be drawn from the original conference talks, scriptures, and references shown by the bot. It is still capable of mistakes. Never directly quote the bot.

Using AI:

AI is a useful tool for refining information, asking general questions and understanding policy.

It should never be used for spiritual guidance, reflections, or in the place of human communication.

Good for writing information communication.

Bad for writing a spiritual message for your class.

Can I use social media posts?

Yes, but only from the official church social media pages. Never use a video or picture from a secondary/fan account.

Can I use devotionals or BYU talks?

Yes, any talk given by the apostles and prophets can be used in class.

Can I show scenes from The Chosen?

No. While spiritual in nature and encouraging spiritually, The Chosen filming team is not in affiliation with the LDS church and cannot be used in official class curriculum.



Attendance

Manual attendance must be taken for accurate records

Zoom recordings, Zoom reports are inaccurate and do not reflect correct student count or time of attendance.

If a student does not turn on their camera for the duration of the class, or participate with audio or participate in chat they will not be anywhere on the recording.

User reports have stated that Zoom Reports also does not accurately reflect participants and the time attended.

What can I use for attendance?

This can be a paper, spreadsheet, or screenshot. (For international classes do your best, but remember that the main focus is the spirit of the class not attendance accuracy.)

According to the current syllabus, weekly Religion gatherings are an essential part of the course. Students are expected to attend, arrive on time, stay for the entire gathering, and participate. Missing gatherings or leaving early may negatively affect both their learning and their final grade.

Students need to be present for a majority of the class and participate fully.

Students are *encouraged but not required* to have cameras on, audio working, or participate in chat as much as possible.

Any policy for your particular class regarding attendance in your class (a point system or time frame requirement) must be communicated to students in clear instructions.



Missionary Care Package

Missionary Care Package

The missionary care package is sent to all new missionaries before the start of their first term.

New teacher checklist: Checklist for new teachers and weekly class checklist

[Checklist](#)

Introduction page/ Devotional sign up page: Instructions on how to insert an introduction page and devotional sign up into your course.

[Introduction](#), [Devotional](#)

Instructor Standards and Expectations:

[Docx](#)

Zoom settings for personal meeting room/ substitute

[Zoom settings](#)

Liahona Zone Excel teacher list

[Liahona Zone Exl](#)

Reflections

Reflections

Encourage students to have a deep meaningful reflection.

For international classes

Google translate is an appropriate way to convey reflections when english skills feel lacking.

Using AI for reflections is not allowed. For international classes this may need to be reiterated.

If you suspect AI was used for a reflection:

Go to [GPTZero.me](https://gptzero.me) copy and paste the reflection into the text box and press check.

It will tell you if it was human, or what percent was AI.

If it comes back as AI, respectfully contact your student and let them know they will need to resubmit their reflection to get full points.

Commenting on Reflections should always be with kindness and respect.

Using reflections in lessons, as examples, or quotes should always be with explicit permission from the student.

Elder Gong, June 2026 “Use Technology Wisely”

Artificial intelligence can answer questions, but it cannot answer prayers. It can organize information, but it cannot offer revelation, covenant connection, or divine truth.

In our personal lives, please use AI for logistics and drafts, but not as a substitute for trusted relationships. Set boundaries.

International classes

If you are an english speaker these courses will be in english.
Some students are new to english and may have a hard time reading or speaking without thick accents.
Closed caption can be turned on by clicking *More*.

Time zone

Make sure you are listing the class time accurate to the area of your class.

*I always list my time of meeting like this:

Class time: **Thursdays 5pm** (UTC-6) (Salt Lake City, Utah, USA Time- 8:00 pm)

*Google what time it is in Salt Lake City to make sure your on time for class.

Tips

- ❖ Set announcements to auto post one hour before class to remind students at the start of class time.
- ❖ No video? Ask student to change their profile pictures to a picture of themselves. That way you can see their faces instead of a black screen.
- ❖ Break out rooms: Even if you do not have a very talkative class, breakout rooms can encourage students who would not usually speak to feel like they have a space among peers to speak.
- ❖ Assigning a leader can help them draw others out of their shell.
- ❖ When struggling with communication remember to make things clear beyond just words. Big hellos and big goodbyes help students understand the beginning and end of class.

Whats app

This can be an encouraging tool for your class communication due to data costs for students.

However it is not required and should not be used in replacement of canvas or zoom. Prayerfully consider this resource for your particular class.



Remember that we are building the foundations of good student behavior with the mercy and grace of Christlike instruction. Be mindful, kind, and understanding that these students are doing their best and we have the opportunity to handle them with mercy.